

RailCore Growth Pathway Program

Manager & Employee Track

Worksheet Packet

Creating Meaningful IDPs Through Conversation, Action, and Follow-Up

Instructions: Use this packet during the workshop to analyze IDP examples, prepare for development conversations, document system practice, draft your own IDP, and commit to follow-up actions.

Participant Name	
Role / Team	
Manager Name	
Session Date	
Follow-up Date	

Worksheet Packet Contents

No.	Worksheet	Purpose
1	IDP Journey and Role Clarity Map	Clarify process steps and role ownership.
2	IDP Quality Checklist	Define what a strong IDP looks like.
3	Fix the Weak IDP	Practice improving vague goals.
4	IDP Conversation Model and Question Bank	Prepare for a meaningful development conversation.
5	CRM / System Guided Practice Checklist	Document or review IDPs consistently.
6	IDP Draft Worksheet	Draft one clear goal, action, support request, and follow-up checkpoint.
7	Peer / Manager Review Checklist	Improve draft quality using feedback.
8	Follow-Up Commitment Card	Confirm next steps after training.

Core message: Employees own their development. Managers support the conversation. Leaders reinforce the system.

Worksheet 1: IDP Journey and Role Clarity Map

Use this worksheet to clarify how the IDP process works and who owns each part of it.

Instructions: Review each IDP step. Add notes about what you personally need to do and where the process may need extra attention.

IDP Step	What Happens	Employee Responsibility	Manager Responsibility	Notes / Risks
Reflect	Employee identifies goals, strengths, gaps, interests.			
Discuss	Manager and employee discuss development direction.			
Plan	Employee and manager select actions, support, timeline.			
Document	IDP is entered or updated in the system.			
Follow Up	Progress is reviewed and adjusted regularly.			

The step I need most support with:	
My key responsibility in the IDP process:	
One question I still have:	

Worksheet 2: IDP Quality Checklist

Use this checklist to evaluate sample IDPs and improve your own IDP draft.

Instructions: Check whether each quality standard is visible. Use the notes column to identify what needs to be improved.

Quality Standard	What to Look For	Yes / Partial / No	Notes
Clear development goal	Specific skill, behavior, capability, or career direction.	☐ Yes ☐ Partial ☐ No	
Connection to role/team/career	Relevant to current role, team needs, or future opportunity.	☐ Yes ☐ Partial ☐ No	
Specific development action	Clear action the employee will take to build the skill.	☐ Yes ☐ Partial ☐ No	
Manager support/resources	Support, feedback, mentoring, access, or resources are identified.	☐ Yes ☐ Partial ☐ No	
Timeline or milestone	Target date or progress checkpoint is included.	☐ Yes ☐ Partial ☐ No	
Evidence of progress	Describes how progress will be observed or discussed.	☐ Yes ☐ Partial ☐ No	
Follow-up rhythm	Manager and employee agree when to revisit the plan.	☐ Yes ☐ Partial ☐ No	

Quick Test: Can someone clearly understand what will be developed, how, by when, and with what support?

Worksheet 3: Fix the Weak IDP

Practice turning vague development statements into clear, actionable IDP components.

Instructions: Choose one weak IDP statement. Improve it using the structure below and the IDP Quality Checklist.

Weak IDP examples:

- I want to become a better leader.
- I want to improve technical skills.
- I want to get promoted.
- I want to communicate better.
- I want to learn more about operations.

Selected weak IDP statement:	
Improved development goal:	
Why this matters:	
Development action:	
Support needed:	
Timeline and follow-up checkpoint:	

Tip: A stronger IDP should be specific, connected to work, action-oriented, supported, time-bound, and followed up.

Worksheet 4: IDP Conversation Model and Question Bank

Use this guide to prepare for a useful manager-employee IDP conversation.

Instructions: Managers can use these questions to coach. Employees can use them to prepare more specific answers before the conversation.

Conversation Step	Employee Role	Manager Role	Useful Questions
Reflect	Share goals, strengths, gaps, interests.	Ask open questions and listen.	What skill do you want to develop next? What feedback could guide your development?
Align	Connect goals to role or future direction.	Connect goals to team needs and expectations.	How does this connect to your current role? How could this support the team?
Plan	Suggest development actions and support needed.	Help make actions realistic and useful.	What action would help you practice this skill? What support would help?
Commit	Confirm next steps and ownership.	Agree on follow-up and support.	What is the first step? When should we check in?

Micro-Practice

Instructions: Scenario: An employee says, "I want to get promoted soon." Write two questions that could help clarify the goal and turn it into a stronger IDP.

Question 1:	
Question 2:	
What a clearer goal might sound like:	

Worksheet 5: CRM / System Guided Practice Checklist

Use this checklist during the system walkthrough to document or review IDPs consistently.

Instructions: Complete the checklist that matches your role. If the live system is unavailable, use screenshots or the sample IDP scenario.

Sample Scenario: Jordan Lee - Operations Coordinator

Goal: Improve cross-functional communication during service disruption updates. Action: Shadow one experienced coordinator, lead two update briefings, collect feedback from manager and dispatcher.

Timeline: 60 days. Follow-up: Monthly check-in.

Employee Practice Steps	Completed	Notes
Open the IDP form or system page	☐	
Enter a development goal	☐	
Add development actions	☐	
Add support needed	☐	
Add timeline or target date	☐	
Save or submit the IDP	☐	
Update progress notes if applicable	☐	

Manager Practice Steps	Completed	Notes
Locate employee IDPs	☐	
Review goal and development action	☐	
Add feedback or comments	☐	
Return for revision if needed	☐	
Confirm follow-up date	☐	
Track progress or status	☐	

Worksheet 6: IDP Draft Worksheet

Draft or refine one IDP component you can continue after training.

Instructions: Employees should draft their own IDP goal. Managers may draft their own IDP goal or review a sample employee IDP if needed.

My development goal:	
Why this goal matters:	
Development action I will take:	
Support or resources I need:	
Timeline or milestone:	
Evidence of progress:	
Follow-up checkpoint:	

Self-check before review	Mark when ready
My goal is specific.	☐
My action is practical and connected to work.	☐
I identified manager support or resources.	☐
I included a timeline or milestone.	☐
I identified how progress will be reviewed.	☐

Worksheet 7: Peer / Manager Review Checklist

Use this checklist to give practical feedback on an IDP draft.

Instructions: Review your partner's draft. Give one strength and one suggestion. Keep feedback specific and supportive.

Review Question	Yes / Partial / No	Feedback Notes
Is the goal specific and clear?	☐ Yes ☐ Partial ☐ No	
Is the development action practical and connected to work?	☐ Yes ☐ Partial ☐ No	
Is there manager support or a resource identified?	☐ Yes ☐ Partial ☐ No	
Is there a timeline or milestone?	☐ Yes ☐ Partial ☐ No	
Is there a follow-up checkpoint?	☐ Yes ☐ Partial ☐ No	

One strength in this IDP draft:	
One suggestion to improve the draft:	
One coaching question I would ask:	

Worksheet 8: Follow-Up Commitment Card

Confirm your next action and follow-up rhythm after the workshop.

Instructions: Complete the statements that apply to your role. Be specific enough that you can act on the commitment within the next 1-4 weeks.

As an employee, my next IDP action is:	
As a manager, my next IDP action is:	
The person I need to follow up with is:	
My follow-up date or rhythm is:	
Support or resource I need:	

Remember

An IDP is not complete when it is submitted. It becomes valuable when it leads to a clear conversation, practical action, and regular follow-up.

Signature	Date
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